

GreenThreads – Case Brief

AI.205 · Capstone 1 · Summer 2026

Who You Are

You don't work for GreenThreads. You're the consultants they hired.

Your team is a five-person AI consulting firm. GreenThreads is your client. They have a store to open and nobody to open it with, and they brought you in to find where AI can carry the load.

Your deliverable is not a report. It's a **working AI-powered analyst** — a designed, documented AI workflow that does a real GreenThreads job. You are not the analyst. You are the team that *builds* the analyst.

This is a real job, and it's the one to want. Companies call it a **forward deployed engineer**: you go into a business, learn how the work actually happens, and convert it to AI.

The Mandate

"Denver opens in 90 days. No new headcount.

Show me where AI absorbs the load." — **Marcus, CEO**

Store #13. \$450,000. Ninety days. Zero new corporate hires.

One clarification, because it trips everyone: *no new headcount* means no new **corporate** roles — no analysts, no coordinators, nobody at HQ. The Denver store still needs its floor staff hired. That's the job HR has to pull off with the team they already have.

The Denver Store

A 3,200 sq ft store on a 7-day week, roughly 11 hours a day. That's about 77 store-hours to cover, with two to four people on the floor at any time. It takes 14 people:

Role	Headcount	Type	Reports to
Store Manager	1	Full-time	Regional lead (HQ)

Role	Headcount	Type	Reports to
Assistant Manager	2	Full-time	Store Manager
Sales Associate	8	Mostly part-time	Assistant Manager
Stock Associate	2	Part-time	Assistant Manager
Visual Merchandiser	1	Part-time	Store Manager
Total	14		

Sales Associate is the whole problem: 8 of the 14 seats, the highest turnover, and the hardest to fill fast. **Seven of the 14 are already accepted. Seven are not, and the clock is at 90 days.**

Your Client Contacts

Marcus — CEO. Gut-driven, expansion-focused. He set the clock. He's the audience for your final presentation, and he wants to hear that Denver opens.

Jennifer — CFO, second-in-command. Data-driven, cautious. She controls the money, she signs off on your work, and she asks how you know. GreenThreads raised a Series B eighteen months ago, so she answers to a board that expects discipline instead of vibes.

They are not aligned. That's the engagement. **Your PM is the single point of contact to Jennifer.** All questions, updates, and sign-off all run through your PM.

The Company

Sustainable apparel — eco-friendly clothing sold in stores and online.

- 12 stores. Denver is #13. The recent run: Seattle → Portland → Austin.
- Series B, ~\$40M revenue, not yet profitable. Growth is funded, but every dollar gets watched.
- Two channels: retail and e-commerce. Four marketing channels: Instagram, Google Ads, email, Facebook.
- Customers are environmentally conscious. Austin's survey: location 8.7, cleanliness 9.1, inventory selection 7.8, overall experience 8.4.
- Competitors: REI and Patagonia, both deeply established in Denver, plus regional sustainable brands.

The Products

GreenThreads sells eight SKUs across its 12 stores. Denver launches with four of them.

Product	Supplier (country)	Lead	MOQ	Cost	MSRP	Margin
Classic Tee	Delta Organics (India)	45 d	500	\$14.25	\$38	62.5%
Active Shorts	Mekong Textile Co. (Vietnam)	60 d	300	\$22.00	\$58	62.1%
Bamboo Joggers	Song Hong Apparel (Vietnam)	65 d	250	\$30.00	\$78	61.5%
EcoFleece Hoodie	Andes Knitworks (Colombia)	30 d	200	\$38.00	\$98	61.2%

The other four — Performance Polo, Organic Tank Top, Slim Chino, Recycled Denim Jacket — are in the GreenThreads catalog and stocked at other stores, but they are **not in the Denver launch assortment**. Don't plan around them, don't budget for them, don't market them. They're in the SKU catalog marked `In_Denver_Launch = N` so you can see the full catalog your client actually sells.

Four SKUs, not eight, is a deliberate call by your client: fewer SKUs means deeper stock on each one and fewer supplier relationships to manage against a 90-day clock. The full opening buy is \$110,000 at cost / \$287,800 at retail — all four SKUs, roughly six weeks of stock.

Read the lead times again. You have 90 days. The Bamboo Joggers take 65 of them. That order has to be placed within the next 25 days or Denver opens with empty shelves — and that assumes the supplier hits their date. Check whether they do.

Two of the four come from Vietnam, and they are **half the opening inventory buy — \$54,900 of \$110,000**. There's an active typhoon-season risk on that lane. Nobody has hedged it.

What AI is Doing at GreenThreads Today

Almost nothing. A few people use ChatGPT unofficially. Nothing is built into any workflow. There's an IT team but **no data or analytics function** — reporting is ad hoc, and it's somebody's Friday afternoon.

There's also **no AI policy**. Nobody has said what can be fed to a public tool, and GreenThreads holds real customer data and real employee data. That's not permission. That's the gap your guardrail closes.

The Denver Market

Measure	Value
Metro population	~3.08M across ~1.29M households
Median household income	\$108,516 — well above national
Median age	35.3
Bachelor's degree or higher	~half the metro
Retail vacancy	4.4% — very tight, almost no new construction

Colorado is a top-three outdoor apparel state. Nationally, sustainably marketed products are 24.8% of retail spending, eco-shoppers pay a 26.6% premium, and 48% of interested consumers say they can't find sustainable brands. That last number is the opening.

The Budget

Line	Amount
Buildout & fixtures	\$150,000
Opening inventory	\$110,000
Marketing & launch	\$85,000
Staffing & recruiting	\$65,000
Tech & systems	\$20,000
Contingency	\$20,000
Total	\$450,000

Austin launched on \$350K and did ~\$1.67M in year one. Denver's target is ~\$2.1M.

Your Data

Each team gets a dataset. It's real enough to be wrong in interesting ways. Check it before you trust it. All files are in the Case Pack on Campuswire.

Team	File
All	GT_SKU_Catalog.csv 8 SKUs, suppliers, lead times, costs, order deadlines
Operations	GT_Ops_Inbound_Shipments.csv 96 POs over 180 days, promised vs. actual
Finance	GT_Finance_Denver_Budget.csv , GT_Finance_Spend_Transactions.csv , GT_Finance_Austin_Store_Daily.csv
Marketing A	GT_MarketingA_Channel_Performance.csv Austin launch, 30 days × 4 channels
Marketing B	GT_MarketingB_Customers.csv 280 customers, orders and spend
HR	GT_HR_Denver_Applicants.csv 148 applicants for 14 Denver roles

Fixed Facts — Don't Change These

- SKU costs, MSRPs, lead times, MOQs, and suppliers as listed
- Denver launches with four SKUs. The other four are catalog-only
- The Denver store is 14 people, structured as above. Seven seats are still open
- Marketing ROI per \$1 spent:
 - Instagram \$6.20 · Google \$5.10 · Email \$4.00 · Facebook \$3.00
- Austin survey scores as listed
- Series B; ~\$40M revenue; not yet profitable
- Competitors are REI, Patagonia, and regional sustainable brands
- The Marcus/Jennifer tension is structural. Don't resolve it — work with it

Open — You Decide, But Say So

Company history before the Series B:

- the org chart below Marcus and Jennifer
- price positioning against REI and Patagonia
- rent and which Denver neighborhood
- what “success” means beyond opening on time
- anything the data doesn't cover.

The rule: an assumption you state is analysis. An assumption you hide is a hole. Marcus won't notice. Jennifer will.